

Another great project is GData Client Tools, which provides the source code and libraries for a variety of languages to access data using the GData APIs. Now, the said APIs provide a protocol for data accessing and publishing on the web.

The Sitemap Generator is a nifty little script that makes your Web site more Google-friendly. It provides tools that automatically create a sitemap, which can then be submitted to Google for better search returns.

1.6 Project Hosting

Project Hosting is a new addition to Google Code, and reads a very interesting tagline: “Release early, release often.” This allows users to post their own projects on Google Code. The projects have been classified under Python, C++, Java, Database, etc., and the user can also search for specific projects using the search function.

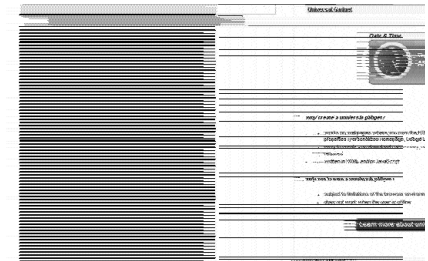
Creating and submitting a new project is very simple. On the same page, click on the “Create a new page” link, and provide some information pertaining to the project. Among other things, you need to select a license under which the project will be provided. The license will decide how others can use or access the project. Also, the label under which the project fits needs to be specified.

1.7 Google Code Search

Code Search is the one-stop place for searching through piles of publicly-accessible source code available on the Internet. It is like a programmer’s almanac, wherein one can even search for function definitions and sample code. The Google Code Search is different from the standard search feature available on code.google.com—more about this later in this book.

1.8 Google Gadgets

These are very small applications that integrate with the Google homepage, Google Desktop, or any page on the Web to enhance the user experience. Examples include calendars and media players—you will find 40 of these



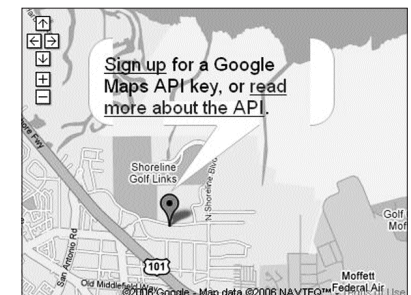
A Google Gadget

gadgets on this month’s *Digit* Special CD. Google Gadgets come in two variants: universal gadgets and desktop gadgets.

The variants serve different purposes. While universal gadgets can be used on Web pages, desktop gadgets can be used within Google Desktop. These make integration with various other Google applications much more easier, and can be customised to react to user defined actions.

1.9 The Google Maps API

The Google Maps API allows the user to embed Google Maps into their own Web pages. It does this through JavaScript. As of now, it is an ad-free service (though there is a possibility that it might go paid). To begin with, create an API key that links your Web site and the specified directory



The Google Maps API

(during the key creation). Thereafter, integrating Google Maps is really easy—all you need to do is add the Google JavaScript code to the page, and voila—you have a new addition to your Web presence.